authoritarian states.

Sudden changes in the government of a state are also a source of changes in the course of foreign policy. For example, changes of government in Pakistan, from military regime to democratically elected government for a brief period in the past and a new democratic governmental coalition after the general election of 2008, have led to some changes in their foreign policy outlook. Similarly, changes in governments in India also have influenced foreign policy choices from time to time. For instance, irrespective of the government in power whether it is a full-fledged Congress led government, or a BJP led NDA coalition, or a Janata Dal led government, or Congress–UPA government—there have been changes in foreign policy stances.

7. *Social Structure:* Foreign policy cannot be generated in a vacuum. Just as political inputs are important, social factors too are important. A strong cohesive society provides chances for a strong foreign policy, whereas, a society with tensions along ethnonational or religious factors or societies with unequal distribution of wealth have a strong possibility of pursuing a weak policy due to the lack of cohesion and cooperation among various groups. Thus, it is not possible to ignore the internal components of the external policy of a state.

8. *Ideology:* Ideology is defined as a cluster of interrelated, though not necessarily logically interdependent, ideas about government, economies, society and history. Ideology does often come to play an important role in the conduct of foreign policies of states. But most often, ideological principles are used by states or group of states, to advance national interests through justifying or disguising their policies and deeds in the struggle for power. The operation of ideology many a time is a source of international conflict. The rise of Fascism and Nazism had a profound impact in the international ideological arena. After the Second World War, the world witnessed strong ideological overtones in the foreign policy objectives of Soviet Russia and the United States. The struggle was between communism and efforts of Western democracies to ‘contain’ communism. However, one should not overestimate the importance